CLASS 7 — SOCIAL_SCIENCE · MEDIUM LEVEL UNIT TEST SET 1

Chapters 5–8: **Cities and States: The Second Urbanisation, The Rise of Empires, The Age of Reorganisation, The Gupta Era** | RBSE Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 2 Hours Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 50**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Q. 1–15 are Objective Type (1 mark each).
3. Q. 16–20 are Very Short Answer Type (2 marks each).
4. Q. 21–25 are Short Answer Type (3 marks each).
5. Q. 26–27 are Long Answer Type (5 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 24–25 and Q. 26–27.
7. Write the question number before each answer.
8. Medium level: multi-step questions.

SECTION — A (Objective Type Questions) 15 × 1 = 15

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

1. Why did the Ganga plains support many mahajanapadas? 1

(a) fertile land, iron and trade routes **(b)** desert climate
(c) no people **(d)** no rivers

2. Why did Magadha's rulers shift the capital from Rajagriha to Pataliputra? 1

(a) to be near desert **(b)** for no reason
(c) to avoid rivers **(d)** to control the Ganga trade and land

3. Why is the age after the Mauryas called an age of reorganisation? 1

(a) many regional kingdoms rose and trade networks expanded
(b) only wars
(c) one empire ruled
(d) no kingdoms existed

4. Why is the Prayaga Prashasti useful to historians? 1

(a) it is a map
(b) it is a coin
(c) it is a tax record
(d) it describes Samudragupta's conquests and ideals

5. Why was Pataliputra's location good? 1

(a) in a forest **(b)** in a mountain
(c) in a desert **(d)** at the meeting of rivers

6. The Sohgaura copper plate shows 1

(a) trade fair **(b)** tax evasion
(c) war **(d)** state concern for famine relief

7. Why were the Kushanas important for trade? 1

(a) they closed it
(b) they had no coins
(c) they banned trade
(d) they controlled sections of the Silk Route

8. Which was a major contribution of Gupta mathematics? 1

(a) gunpowder **(b)** steam
(c) printing **(d)** decimal place value and zero

9. Why are the early Buddhist and Jain teachers important in this period? 1

(a) they questioned rituals and spread new ideas
(b) they ruled
(c) they fought
(d) they traded

10. Which of these is a similarity between Ashoka and a modern welfare state? 1

(a) war only **(b)** no welfare
(c) taxes only **(d)** provision of wells, hospitals and roads

11. Why do coins of the Kushanas show different gods? 1

(a) one faith only
(b) diverse cultures and faiths in their realm
(c) no gods
(d) no coins

12. What did Gupta rulers' titles like maharajadhiraja show? 1

(a) humility
(b) foreign rule
(c) weakness
(d) claim to supreme power over smaller rulers

13. Why was iron more useful than bronze for farming? 1

(a) it was stronger and more widely available
(b) it was rarer
(c) it was softer
(d) it was costlier

14. Why did Alexander's soldiers refuse to march further east? 1

(a) they had been paid to stop
(b) they had lost their weapons in the Ganga
(c) they had reached Pataliputra and won
(d) they were tired after long campaigns and heavy battles

15. Which factor helped the Satavahanas become rich? 1

(a) no trade **(b)** trade, including sea trade with Rome
(c) no coins **(d)** desert farming

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer Type) 5 × 2 = 10

Answer in about 20–30 words each.

16. Why did iron tools increase farming? 2

17. Why did Alexander turn back? 2

18. Why did the Satavahanas prosper? 2

19. Why is the Gupta era called the Golden Age? 2

20. What did sabha and samiti do? 2

SECTION — C (Short Answer Type) 5 × 3 = 15

Answer in about 40–60 words each.

21. Explain the link between iron, agriculture and cities. 3

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22. Explain how Chandragupta Maurya came to power. 3

23. Explain how trade shaped the economy of the Satavahanas. 3

24. Explain the sources for the Gupta period. 3

OR

Explain how social divisions developed. 3

25. Explain the importance of Ashoka's inscriptions to historians. 3

OR

Describe the role of inscriptions in Kalinga history. 3

SECTION — D (Long Answer Type) 2 × 5 = 10

Answer in about 100–150 words each.

26. Explain the process of the Second Urbanisation and its causes. 5

OR

Explain the rise of Magadha and the Maurya Empire. 5

27. Explain how political and cultural change after the Mauryas shaped India. 5

OR

Explain why the Gupta age is regarded as a classical age. 5

END OF QUESTION PAPER Total: 50 Marks

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